



▲ **WOLFGANG AMADEUS MOZART**
The musical genius Mozart (1756–1791) was born in Salzburg, Austria. He remains one of the most influential classical music composers.

Austria



Area 32,378 sq miles
 (83,858 sq km)
Population 8.4 million
Capital Vienna
Currency Euro
Official language German
Life expectancy 80 years



Austria is dominated by the Alps in the west, while fertile plains form the east and north. Its economy is based on income from high-tech sectors, tourism, and agriculture. Austria's main trading partner is its northern neighbor, Germany.

Slovenia



Area 7,820 sq miles
 (20,253 sq km)
Population 2 million
Capital Ljubljana
Currency Euro
Official language Slovenian
Life expectancy 78 years

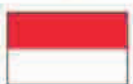


A small country located at the northeastern end of the Adriatic Sea, Slovenia controls some of Europe's major transit routes. It is a former Yugoslav republic that became independent in 1991. Slovenes are of the same ethnicity as the neighboring Croats.

Monaco



Area 0.75 sq miles
 (1.95 sq km)
Population 30,510
Capital Monaco-Ville
Currency Euro
Official language French
Life expectancy 80 years



The Principality of Monaco is a city-state located on the Côte d'Azur, the Mediterranean coastline of southeastern France. Monaco is a lucrative banking center. It is also a popular tourist spot, especially since the opening of the Monte Carlo casino by Prince Charles III in 1863.

Switzerland



Area 15,942 sq miles
 (41,290 sq km)
Population 7.7 million
Capital Bern
Currency Swiss franc
Official languages French, German, Italian, and Romansch
Life expectancy 82 years



Switzerland, one of the most prosperous countries in the world, lies at the center of western Europe. Its foreign policy has remained largely neutral, without favoring any country in most of the European conflicts since 1815. Switzerland has so far not joined the EU.



▲ **SWISS CHEESE**
Cheese making has been a Swiss tradition for hundreds of years. Swiss cheese typically has a mild flavor and characteristic holes.

Germany



Area 137,846 sq miles
 (357,021 sq km)
Population 82.2 million
Capital Berlin
Currency Euro
Official languages German
Life expectancy 79 years



Germany is bordered by nine countries, with coastlines on both the Baltic and North seas. Germany is Europe's foremost industrial power, and the world's second-biggest exporter. In 1945, after the defeat of Adolf Hitler's Nazi regime at the end of World War II, Germany was divided into East Germany and West Germany. The country was reunited in 1990 with the collapse of

the Communist East German government. However, the east remains economically poorer, with many people choosing to migrate to the west for better opportunities. The German government is led by an elected chancellor. In 2005, Angela Merkel became the first female chancellor. By and large, women play a bigger role in German politics than in most other European countries. Germany was one of the original 12 nations to adopt the Euro in 2002.

► **BAVARIA, GERMANY**
With traditional German architecture and first-rate museums, Bavaria is said to be one of the most scenic travel destinations in Germany.

